

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 2: THE PHOTOGRAPH

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - BREAKFAST ROOM - MORNING

The morning after the funeral. Kunle has three phones beside his plate. Yewande reads the codicil on a tablet. Tobi stands by the window.

KUNLE

He will make this sentimental.

TOBI

He was named in the will.

YEWANDE

The name is not the problem. The timing is.

TOBI

The timing was chosen by the man who signed it.

KUNLE

We need Mr. Obi to believe he has a choice.

TOBI

You are already planning how to remove it.

Mrs. Adeyemi puts down her spoon.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Let the lawyers work. Your father has been dead one day.

KUNLE

The company cannot wait for grief.

CUT TO:

EXT. OBI FAMILY HOME - FRONT VERANDA - MORNING

Mr. Obi brings Ify tea. A black sedan stops at the gate. Tobi approaches with the executor's appointment notice.

IFY

You knew Chief before you worked for him.

MR. OBI

I knew him before the company had a name.

IFY

What happened to that life?

MR. OBI

It became expensive.

Tobi offers the folder.

TOBI

The formal offer is tomorrow afternoon. My brother is speaking as if you have accepted.

MR. OBI

He has always spoken ahead of himself.

IFY

And you?

TOBI

I am trying to catch up.

MR. OBI

To what?

TOBI

To the part of my father I never asked about.

Mr. Obi takes the folder but does not open it.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - RECEPTION - DAY

A glass reception overlooks the loading yard. Ify and Tobi arrive with a written archive request.

RECEPTIONIST

The archive is closed.

IFY

Good. We have a written request.

Yewande appears from the corridor.

YEWANDE

You have one hour. Read only what the executor authorised.

IFY

We are not taking anything.

YEWANDE

Access is not belonging.

IFY

I am not the one who needs that reminder.

Yewande steps aside. Tobi unlocks the archive.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - ARCHIVE ROOM - DAY

Dusty boxes fill metal shelves. Ify puts on gloves. Tobi reads dates while she searches names.

IFY

Obi and Adeyemi Trading. Two names before the company became yours.

TOBI

My grandfather's initials are here. So are your father's.

IFY

Emmanuel Afolabi. Legal adviser. File seventeen-B.

TOBI

Someone wanted him difficult to find.

IFY

Or he wanted to be difficult to find.

She opens a ledger. A photograph slips from between the pages but lands face down.

TOBI

We have five minutes.

IFY

Then choose what you will regret not taking.

Tobi hears footsteps outside. They slide the photograph back into the ledger and carry the ledger to a worktable.

CUT TO:

EXT. COMPANY LOADING YARD - EVENING

Trucks move through rain-dark concrete. Ify and Tobi stand beneath a warehouse awning.

TOBI

I was told not to come to the mainland.

IFY

And you listened.

TOBI

I was fifteen.

IFY

So was I.

TOBI

I am here now.

IFY

Now is an expensive time to arrive.

TOBI

Then I will pay attention.

A truck horn cuts through the silence. Tobi looks toward the old warehouse.

TOBI

Your father said the first company was here.

IFY

He said very little.

TOBI

Paper may say more.

CUT TO:

INT. OBI FAMILY HOME - SITTING ROOM - NIGHT

The appointment folder lies unopened. Mr. Obi locks the front door twice.

IFY

Why lock it?

MR. OBI

Because I asked.

IFY

That is not a reason.

MR. OBI

It is the reason I have.

A message from Tobi appears on Ify's phone: THE ARCHIVE IS OPEN TONIGHT.

MR. OBI

Do not go back there.

IFY

You are afraid of a room full of paper.

MR. OBI

I am afraid of what people do after they read it.

Ify looks at the locked door, then at her father.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI OPERATING BUSINESS - ARCHIVE ROOM - NIGHT

A single desk lamp. Tobi has reopened the ledger. Ify pulls out the photograph.

It shows two boys beside a low compound wall: OLUMIDE ADEYEMI and OBINNA OBI, laughing in school clothes.

IFY

Your father said they barely knew each other.

TOBI

He never said that.

IFY

My father did.

She turns the photograph over. On the back: OLUMIDE AND OBINNA - AFTER THE RAIN.

IFY

He lied to me.

TOBI

Maybe he was trying to survive the truth.

IFY

What happened after they grew up?

The archive light flickers. Somewhere outside, a key turns in a lock.

FADE OUT.